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Bahir Dar Institute Of Technology- Bahir Dar University

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Department of Human Nutrition

Nutrition Program Planning and Management

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Chapter 1: Introduction

Chapter objectives

- By the end of this chapter, you will be able to:
 - Differentiate project and program
 - Define program planning and management
 - Discuss general features of program planning
 - Identify merits and demerits of planning
 - Discuss the basics of program management

Introduction

- To be an effective nutrition officer at all levels,
 - ✓ needs knowledge & skills in project planning & management
- Success & failure of most nutrition programs depend,
 - ✓ managerial skills
- Most courses do not provide exposure to nutrition project/program management
 - ✓ experiences are usually acquired through trial & error
- Planning & management skills are urgently needed
 - ✓ to identify priority problems, develop plans, secure necessary resources, and implement & evaluate nutrition programs...

Basic Definitions

■ Project?

- ✓ A series of activities that brings objectives within a defined time-period and budget
- ✓ It is a series of structured tasks, activities, and deliverables that are carefully executed to achieve a desired outcome
- ✓ Tasks are completed by a group of people known as the project team, which is led by a project manager

■ Program?

- ✓ A series of projects whose objectives together contribute to a common objective at sector, country or multi-country level
- ✓ E.g, National Nutrition Program (NNP), Community-Based Nutrition Program (CBN), the Essential Nutrition Actions (ENA) program, Community Management of Acute Malnutrition (CMAM)...



Basic Definitions...(2)

▪ **Program planning**

- ✓ Process of thinking & organizing the activities
- ✓ Setting objectives, targets & formulating an action plan
- ✓ Program planning: strategize and coordinate related projects
- ✓ Project planning: focuses on specific tasks, timelines & resources

▪ **Program management**

- ✓ Harmonizing efforts and resources towards goals and objectives
- ✓ Process of managing related projects having a common goal
- ✓ It involves coordinating projects to improve performance
- ✓ More inclusive (consists of all management functions)
- ✓ Program planning is one of them

Levels of planning

- Two levels of planning: “strategic” and “operational”

Strategic planning:–

- Guides the *overall direction of an organization*
- Defines its vision and mission and goals or strategic objectives
 - ✓ usually covers long term period (minimum of 3 or 4 years- 10 years)

Operational planning

- Describes how the objectives will be achieved on the ground
 - ✓ usually covers short term period (months- three years)

NB

- Strategic and operational planning have a cyclical relationship;
 - ✓ experience from operational planning used for strategic planning
 - ✓ strategic planning show general direction for operational planning

Good features of Program planning (1)

a. A primary function of management

- ✓base for all other functions of program management

b. Goal-oriented/purposeful

- ✓made to achieve desired objectives/goals

c. Pervasive or all-encompassing

- ✓not exclusive function of top management
- ✓required at all levels of management
(top/middle and lowest)

d. Planning is a mental exercise

- ✓requires logical and systematic thinking
- ✓rather than guess work or wishful thinking



e. Planning is futuristic

- ✓ a forward looking based on forecasting

f. Planning is continuous process

- ✓ prepared for a specific period of time (month, a quarter, or a year)
- ✓ But it has cyclic nature:-
 - *framed–implemented–followed by another plan–and so on*

g. Planning is designed for efficiency

- ✓ Aims to accomplish objectives at the minimum possible cost
- ✓ leads to saving and proper utilization of resources
 - *time, effort, methods, materials and money...*

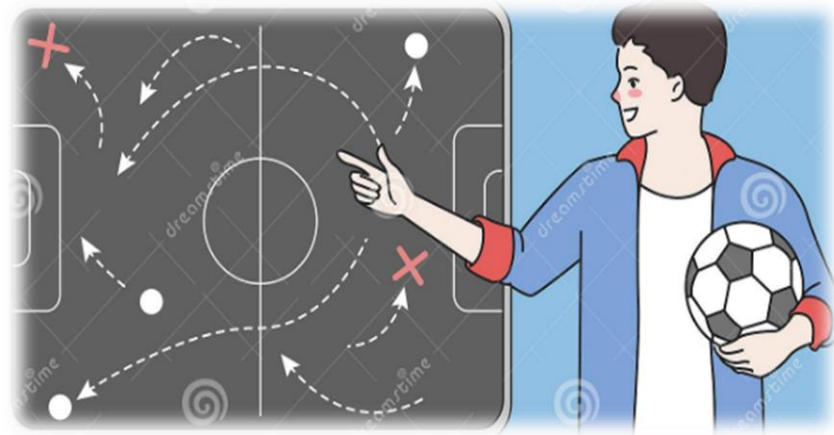
Importance/merits of planning



Importance/merits of planning...(2)

1.Provides directions

- i.e. where to go
- ensures that the goals or objectives are clearly stated



2. Facilitates decision making

- Helps to look into the future & make a choice from alternative courses of actions
- ✓ Thus, it facilitates *decision making*



Importance/merits of planning...(3)

3. Reduces the risks of uncertainty

- Helps to anticipate risks and develop managerial responses

4. Reduces overlapping & wasteful activities

- Helps to coordinate activities & efforts of different divisions, departments and individuals
- It reduces overlap of activities and waste of resources

5. Establishes standards for controlling

- Provides the goals (targets) to measure actual performance
- Helps to evaluate to what extent that set targets are met



Demerits of planning

- It is difficult to manage projects without planning
 - ✓ But, things do not always go according to plan
- Unforeseen events and changes affect plans and may need to be modified
 - ✓ rise in costs and prices, environmental changes, government interventions, legal regulations etc...
- ✓ Hence, planning should be adaptable changes

If not, what do you think are disadvantages of planning?

Demerits of planning ...(1)

i. Planning leads to rigidity:

- When a plan is adhered too strictly, it can become inflexible and unable to adapt to changing circumstances
- Managers may not be willing to change it (remain rigid)
 - ✓ Prevents flexibility to cope with the changed circumstances

ii. Planning may not work in a dynamic environment:

- The environment is dynamic, nothing is constant
 - ✓ Planning cannot foresee everything

iii. Planning reduces creativity:

- If plans are done by the top management
 - ✓ Stakeholders at lower levels are neither allowed to deviate from plans nor permitted to plan on their own
 - ✓ all are expected to think along the same lines as others

Demerits of planning ...(2)

iv. Planning involves huge costs:

- Since it requires scientific calculations to ascertain facts and figures, costs sometimes do not justify the benefits
 - ✓ A number of incidental costs/expenses on meetings, discussions with experts, workshops and preliminary investigations to ensure viability of the plan

v. Planning does not guarantee success:

- Managers usually rely on previously tried and tested successful plans
 - ✓ it is not always true that a plan has worked before, it will work again
 - ✓ there are so many other unknown factors to be considered
 - ✓ usually leads to probable results, but may not always be exactly as per expectation

Conclusion!

- Although planning provides clear benefits
 - ✓ to organizations, programs, projects...
- But planning can also harm organizations, programs, projects...
 - ✓ if is not implemented properly

Basic of Program Management

Session objectives

- At the end of this session, students will be able to
 - List functional areas of management
 - Discuss about basic concepts of managing nutrition programs

Basics of program management---(1)

- Management
 - ✓when it is practiced: it is an art
 - ✓organized knowledge about management: it is science
 - The basic functional areas of management are
 - ✓Planning
 - ✓Organizing
 - ✓Staffing
 - ✓Leading
 - ✓Monitoring
 - ✓Coordinating
- 

all are important for program or project success
- Different projects/programs in our country are not observed to be successful, *what do you think is the reason?*
 - A review of failure and success stories in nutrition programs:
 - ✓ *a high % of failures have been due to faulty management*

What is the importance of management?

- Good management is essential for:
 - ✓ coordination of individual efforts towards group goals
 - ✓ success of any project/program

- Aim of management is to establish an environment:
 - ✓ To achieve group goals with
 - least resources (time, money, material, low personal dissatisfaction) and
 - maximum involvement of all stakeholders

Basics of program management---(3)

For example

- **Proof:** A dosage of 200,000 IU of vitamin A every six months protected a child from Xerophthalmia:
- However, several management issues, such as
 - ✓ how to reach the vulnerable children
 - ✓ who would deliver vitamin A
 - ✓ how to ensure that children are taking the vitamin
 - ✓ whether interval of 6 months was being kept between doses ...
- Since many other related questions were not well considered
 - ✓ Many vitamin A supplementation programs did not produce desired result
- Problems in Ethiopia for example:
 - ✓ low parental awareness
 - ✓ inadequate promotion by health professionals
 - ✓ high workload for health extension workers
 - ✓ poor access to healthcare in rural areas
 - ✓ inconsistent supply of supplements
 - ✓ lack of motivation among mothers

Basics of program management---(4)

- Control of iodine deficiency disorders (IDD) is another example of a nutrition program needing managerial skill
 - ✓ Providing iodine through iodized salt is straightforward approach and a simple program to operate
- However, such programs have not succeeded in many cases due to managerial problems:
 - ✓ difficulties in enrolling and controlling salt traders
 - ✓ failure in controlling the level of iodization
 - ✓ problems of transporting iodized salt to different regions
 - ✓ tendency of consumers to use cheaper, non-iodized salt
 - unless price of iodized salt is not subsidized by the government

Basics of program management---(5)

- Management is more important for developing countries

Why?

- ✓ technical, financial & capital resources are very limited
- Based on review of various programs
 - ✓ Economists concluded that provision of resources or technology alone does not bring development
 - Because it is not only financial resources that are limiting factors,
 - but lack of managerial skills necessary to utilize available resources in most effective manner

Chapter 2

Managing and Coordinating Nutrition programs

Chapter objectives

- At the end of this chapter, students will be able to
 - Discuss about functional area of management
 - Explain importance of each functional area of management



Introduction ---(1)

- *If you were a manager of a nutrition project, what activities would you do (from beginning to end)?*
- The basic functional areas of management are
 - ✓ Planning
 - ✓ Organizing
 - ✓ Staffing
 - ✓ Leading
 - ✓ Monitoring
 - ✓ Coordinating
- Functions are the same for any manager: responsibilities fall into above categories
 - ✓ *health or nutrition programs*
 - ✓ *running a factory or*
 - ✓ *in any type of program*

Functional areas of program management ...(1)

1. Planning

- At this stage appropriate courses of actions that a program or project will follow are determined
- For example, in a supplementary feeding program:
 - ✓ planning- outline courses of actions to be followed at central, intermediate and peripheral levels
 - ✓ *Procurement of food & distribution– a central responsibility*
 - ✓ *Supervision– an intermediate responsibility*
 - ✓ *Actual feeding – a peripheral task*
- A program manager develop a plan that addresses:
 - ✓ *Assessment/prioritizing problems, setting objectives/expected outcomes, indicators, targets, monitoring and evaluation mechanisms ...*

Functional areas of program management---(2)

2. Organizing

- People must have roles to play much like actors in a drama
- In such spirit, managers should:
 - ✓ Establish roles of every individual
 - ✓ Develop tasks to groups/individuals best suited to carry out
- For example: in nutrition surveillance program, a manager must assign specific responsibilities to:
 - ✓ Peripheral workers- collect indicator-related data and send to central analytical unit
 - ✓ Supportive supervisors- ensure that this is correctly done
 - ✓ Data analysts- analyzing data & report to decision makers



Functional areas of program management --- (3)

3. Staffing

- Filling necessary positions for objectives/carryout tasks
- It involves
 - ✓ *Setting requirement for the job*
 - ✓ *Assess and select candidates*
 - ✓ *Training- pre and in-service?*
- Previously, personnel specializing in nutrition were not readily available
 - ✓ Personnel from other disciplines:
 - maternal & child health or other, PH, sociology... had to be identified
 - given in-service training
 - assigned to takeover nutritional tasks
- Nowadays???



Functional areas of program management---(4)

4. Leading

- Leadership- most important duty of a manager
- Influencing colleagues and subordinates
 - ✓ *work willingly and passionately*
- Inter-personnel aspects of managing
- Establish appropriate style of leadership
 - ✓ Autocratic/authoritarian leadership - rely on threats and punishment
 - ✓ Transactional leadership - rely in conformity to rules & values of org
 - ✓ Bureaucratic leadership - rely on procedure and policy only
 - ✓ Supportive leadership - center employees than tasks
 - ✓ Participative leadership - encourages employees to be part of decision
 - ✓ Laissez-faire leadership - provide little or no direction/gives freedom
 - ✓ Charismatic leadership - lead by impression of personality than power



Functional areas of program management---(5)

5. Monitoring and evaluation

- Continuous watching, measuring & correcting deviant activities
 - ✓ ensure conformation to agreed plan
- The manager
 - ✓ measures performance against goals and objectives
 - ✓ identifies & corrects negative deviations
 - ✓ ensures attainment of objectives/targets
- However, without an in-built monitoring system,
 - ✓ impossible to know how well the program is progressing
 - *activities based on plans*
 - *budget for expenses*
 - *records of performance etc...*



Functional areas of program management---(5)

6. Coordination

- Runs through all other managerial functions
- Very special important for nutrition programs
 - ✓ *due to its multisectorial nature*
- Effectiveness of programs depend coordination of:
 - ✓ *various sectors & sub-units*
 - ✓ *available resources*
 - ✓ *individuals of different expertise*
 - ✓ *skills and experiences, etc.*



Chapter 3

Planning a Nutrition Program

Chapter Objectives

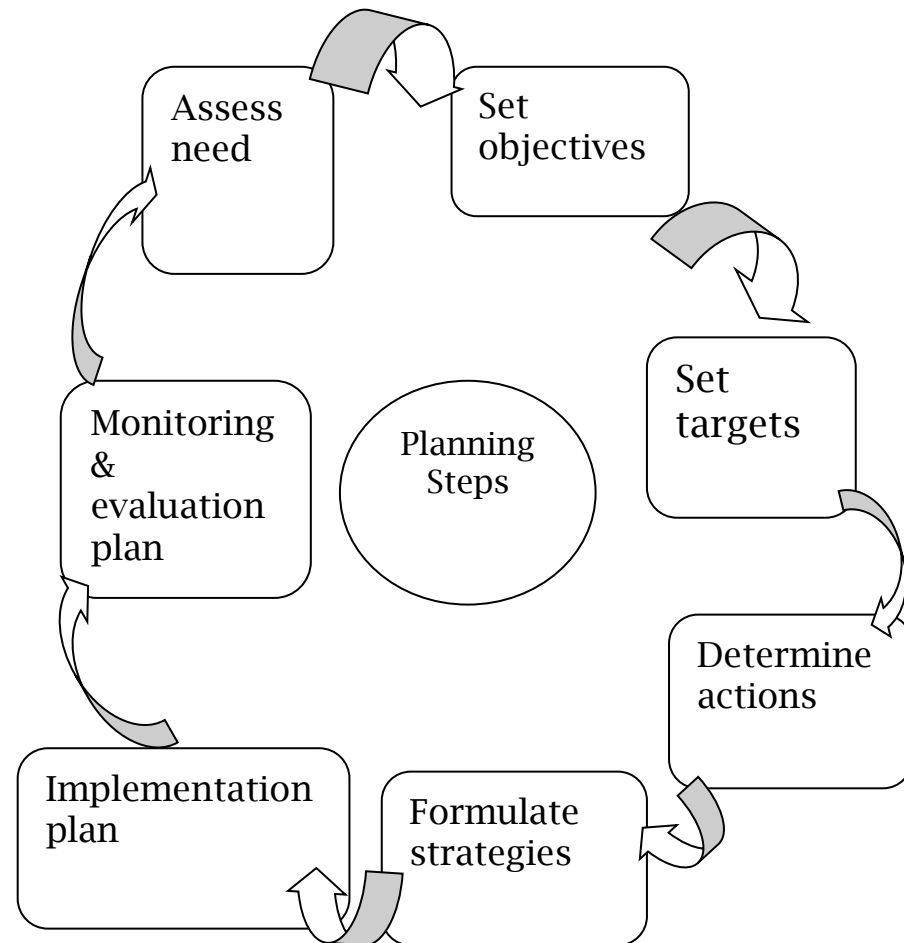
- By the end of this chapter, students will be able to:
 - Discuss about steps/stages in program planning
 - Describe why managers fail in planning

Introduction...(1)

- Panning bridges the gap between where we are & where we want to go
 - ✓ concerned with ends & means (what to be done & how it is to be done)
- If properly planned, a program has every chance of success
- Unfortunately, all nutrition programs are not properly planned
- Improperly planned program will not succeed
 - ✓ irrespective of the soundness of the program
- As program planning is systematic process, there are steps that need to be followed

Steps in program planning...(1)

- i. Awareness of problem
(problem definition)
- i. Establishing objectives
 - ii. Setting targets
 - iii. Determine alternative actions
 - iv. Strategy formulations
 - v. Implementation plan
 - vi. Monitoring and evaluation plan



i. Problem definition...(1)

- Before starting the process of planning,
 - ✓ diagnose the extent and magnitude of the problem
 - ✓ known as problem definition
 - ✓ prerequisite for nutrition program planning
- Problem definition is done by nutrition assessment
 - ✓ a preliminary stage in program planning

What is nutritional assessment? How would it be done?

- However, aggregated surveys may not give a true picture of the problem
- A disaggregated analysis of the problem is necessary
 - ✓ Magnitude for the problem of interest
 - ✓ which age and groups of the population are affected
 - ✓ types of malnutrition/deficiencies exist
 - ✓ regions/areas where problems are more concentrated
 - ✓ indications of the major causes
 - ✓ etc.

Nutrition Assessment...(1)

- No a such sophisticated, expensive, time consuming & comprehensive surveys are needed
- *Simple nutrition assessment are good enough*
 - ✓less costly, quicker & provide results in a short period of time
- Important guidelines for making simple NA:
 - 1)Specify clear objectives
 - 2)Describe the situation and provide explanation
 - 3)Restrict the choice of data to a minimum
 - 4)Limit Large surveys
 - 5)Disaggregate the data
 - 6)Use Interdisciplinary team

Nutritional assessment...guidelines(2)

1)Specify clear objectives

- Before starting NA, objectives must be clearly defined
 - ✓there may be many objectives, but must be prioritized
 - ✓focus on clear objectives and priority areas or groups

2) Describe situation and provide explanation

- The NA should be designed to generate data that
 - ✓identify malnutrition and its causes
 - ✓provide an explanation to the major determinants
 - ✓pinpoint the trends of problems

3) Restrict the choice of data to a minimum

- For the sake of time and financial constraints,
 - ✓ better to restrict the choice of data to a minimum
 - ✓ collect data only relevant to the objectives
 - ✓ use existing sources as far as possible

4)Limit large surveys

- There are largely under-utilized & relevant information
- Surveys are also conducted everywhere
 - ✓ can serves as primary sources of information
 - ✓ access to information may be difficult, but cost-effective
 - it must be *hunted out*

Nutritional assessment...guidelines(4)

5) Disaggregate the data

- Aggregated data often do not adequately reflect reality
- Disaggregation of data depends on factors such as;
 - ✓ location: regional, geographical, urban, rural
 - ✓ socioeconomic, sociocultural or occupational categories
 - ✓ age-groups and physiological categories etc...

6) Use interdisciplinary team

- Multisectoral team understands the problem far better
 - ✓ decisions made by such team have more validity than the judgment of uni-sectoral team

Nutritional assessment...information sources

❑ Sources of information

1.Secondary sources- records, reports, webpages...

2.Primary sources

- ABCD methods
- Qualitative methods: FGD, KII, II etc.

ii. Establishing objectives...(1)

- The next stage in planning a nutrition program is to *establish objective and sub-objectives*
- *Objectives should indicate the expected results*

Example: sub-objectives of one nutrition program:

- ✓ *Reducing the prevalence of undernutrition among children <5*
- ✓ *Developing infrastructure for nutrition services*
- ✓ *Capacitate nutrition workers/improve man power*

- Unclear program objectives, cannot be evaluated

For example:-

- ✓ *Supplementary feeding programs to improve the health and nutritional status of the beneficiaries*
 - Which health/nutritional status?
 - Who are the beneficiaries?

iii. Setting targets ...(1)

- Objectives without targets are incomplete
 - ✓ targets ensure- program runs the tracks- objectives

For example:

- Objective of an IDD control program to eradicate goiter
 - ✓ may take a very long time
- *But, the target might be set as follows:*
 - ✓ *reduce % of goiter in school children by 25% (a 5 years period)*
- However, targets must be realistic-
 - ✓ needs careful consideration of available resources
 - ✓ factors causing the particular type of malnutrition
- Too ambitious targets
 - ✓ difficult to reach with available resources should be avoided

iv. Determining alternative actions...(1)

- No any objective without alternative approaches
- Needs analysis of the benefits of each alternative
 - ✓ *examining the strong and weak points*
- One may be most effective but requires larger capital
 - ✓ while another may be time-consuming but less costly
- *For instance, for control of endemic goiter:*
 - ✓ Salt iodization- least capital and simple to implement
 - but less effective
 - ✓ Iodinated oil injections- effective quickly & simple
 - but needs more capital & well organized infrastructure
- Needs to consider all factors
 - ✓ *to decide actions of most appropriate*

vi. Strategy formulations...(1)

- Once, problems analyzed, objectives & targets set, and alternatives actions determined
- Next?
- Formulation of a strategy!
- Strategy- sets of activities/implementation approaches
- Example
 - ✓ *Social marketing to promote men involvement in iodized salt utilization programs*
 - ✓ *SBCC (increase nutrition information access to the community)*
- Needs consideration of favorable & unfavorable factors
 - ✓ *Favorable factors– available resources*
 - *manpower, equipment , funds...*
 - ✓ *Unfavorable factors– potential obstacles*

vii. Implementation plan...(1)

- Stage where other managerial functions come into place
- Concerned with how to put the plan into action
 - ✓ i.e., how to do, who do it, *what is required*
- For example, if there is objective to increase vegetable production and consumption, plan how:
 - ✓ *awareness creation (social marketing) will be conducted*
 - ✓ *availing inputs (seeds/seedlings etc...) will be implemented*
 - ✓ *trainings (experts/extension service providers) will be organized*

viii. Follow-up action/monitoring plan

- This step involves how to check whether plans are being implemented
 - ✓ whether activities are performed according to schedule
- Monitoring plans
 - ✓ important to ensure that objectives are achieved
- Then, finally evaluation plan must be developed
 - ✓ needs to set out appropriate indicators

Why managers fail in planning?... (1)

- Many reasons- important to be aware of factors

a) Lack of commitments to planning:

- Despite interest, lack of real commitment in planning

b) Lack of meaningful objectives and targets:

- Many nutrition programs- no clear objectives & targets
 - ✓ more likely that such programs will not succeed

c) Failure to develop and implement sound strategies:

- Without sound strategies, plans go in a wrong direction
 - ✓ remain a statement of wishes and hopes

(d) Excessive reliance on experience:

- Although useful, being too dependent on past experience
 - ✓ *makes unable to foresee changes & obstacles*
 - ✓ *use experiences flexibly*

(e) Lack of top management support:

- Planning is not likely to be effective if top managers
 - ✓ *do not believe in it and encourage it*
 - ✓ *do not make the supportive decisions*

(f) Lack of control and monitoring techniques:

- Without a control and monitoring system:-
 - ✓ *even good plans may easily proceed in a wrong direction*

Why managers fail in planning? ...(3)

(f) Lack of clear delegation of authority:

- It is very difficult for people to plan if
 - ✓ *they do not know what their jobs are*
 - ✓ *they are unaware of how their jobs relate to others*
 - ✓ *they do not have clear authority to make decisions*

Chapter 4

Nutrition Advocacy for Program Support

Chapter objectives

- At the end of this chapter, students will be able to
 - Describe nutrition advocacy
 - Discuss the need for nutrition advocacy
 - Identify approaches for nutrition advocacy
 - Apply advocacy tools



Nutrition Advocacy(1)

- Presenting threat of malnutrition & control mechanisms
 - ✓ *to obtain support in financial and manpower resources*
- Particularly to administrators & decision-makers



Nutrition Advocacy...(2)

- Dissemination of information to the public is equally important
 - ✓ *Without the involvement of the people, control of malnutrition will be difficult, sometimes impossible*



- When and why is nutrition advocacy needed?

The need for nutrition advocacy(1)

- May be various reasons for making nutrition advocacy
- Some of basic conditions that may need nutrition advocacy include:
 - 1)Low priority of malnutrition control in the country
 - 2)Low priority of nutrition in the sectors' plans

The need for nutrition advocacy...(2)

1.Low priority of malnutrition control in the country

- Most developing countries are becoming aware:
 - ✓ *recognize impacts of malnutrition and the need for its control*
 - ✓ *many have officials & political statement to the problem*
- However, malnutrition control does not have high priority in socioeconomic plan of any given country
 - ✓ *of course, the situation is gradually changing*
 - ✓ *but still there is an urgent need to assign priority to the problem*

1.Low priority of malnutrition ...reasons?

- Developing countries, even now:
 - ✓ *assume malnutrition as a health problem only*
 - ✓ *do not properly understand the socioeconomic consequences*
- Notion that malnutrition commonly affects poverty-stricken population groups:
 - ✓ *economic development plans alone will take care of it*
- When problems are understood, ways to control are not clear
 - ✓ *although, food sufficiency is regarded as an essential step*
 - ✓ *Wrong attitude: increased food production alone solve problem*
 - ✓ *food distribution and utilization are ignored*

2. Low priority of nutrition in all sectors

- In all sectors of most developing countries
 - ✓ *nutrition has a low priority in their programs*
- Particularly, in competition for financial resources
 - ✓ *nutrition has always taken, and still takes, a “back-seat”*
- Off course, it is improving in these days
 - ✓ *But, a long way to go to receive its pre-recognition*

Why still sectors do not give due attention?

2. Low priority of nutrition in sectors...reasons?

- Effects are usually less visible than other problems
- For example: few cases of cholera in a country
 - ✓ *receives immediate attention of media and government*
- Countless children suffering from severe PEM & VAD
 - ✓ *remain unnoticed*
 - ✓ *it does not call for urgent action*
 - ✓ *sectors are not thus, evaluated against*

Approaches to Nutrition Advocacy (1)

- Nutrition advocacy in developing countries
 - ✓ usually undertaken via scientific conferences & seminars
 - ✓ attended by people who are already “converted”
 - *but not decision-makers*
- Nutrition officers of a given sector do not usually occupy a high level in the sector hierarchy
 - ✓ *But, the decision comes from a higher level*
- Nutrition advocacy should thus, be directed to:
 - Senior administrators/decision-makers
 - General public: create mass awareness



How?

Approaches to Nutrition Advocacy ...(2)

a.Preparation of brief and delivery

- The first step in nutrition advocacy:
 - ✓ preparing a short brief in simple language
 - ✓ preferably illustrated with photographs of actual cases
- The short brief may include
 - ✓ problems exist and their public implications
 - ✓ problems that can be overcome by simple actions

b.Collaboration of national nutrition network

- Nutrition officers/experts
 - ✓ usually have limited power & financial resources
 - ✓ need establish effective linkages
 - ✓ create “pressure groups” to influence decision-makers

c.Utilizing mass media specialists

- Two different approaches:
 - 1) Provide simple information to media for dissemination
 - 2) Organization of workshop/trainings for media specialists✓ media specialists can then develop programs for dissemination
- Radio has been successful in many countries
 - ✓ films/documentaries can produce significant impact
 - ✓ television and video are particularly powerful tools

d.Involve senior administrators in seminars

- ✓ they can be extremely useful in supporting nutrition programs if they are properly involved and converted

Approaches to Nutrition Advocacy ... (4)

e. Involve national planning commission/similar body

- It is powerful sectorial body in developing countries
- Involving it in conferences, workshops, seminars etc.
 - ✓ *gives more “visibility and credibility” to nutrition issues*
 - ✓ *can help to put nutrition with appropriate priority*

f. Social marketing for nutrition

- Social marketing of contraceptives
 - ✓ *successful in many developing countries*
- Nutrition social marketing tried in a few countries
 - ✓ *brought some success*
 - ✓ *but experiences in developing countries are too limited*

Approaches to Nutrition Advocacy ... (5)

g. Facilitate voluntary bodies lead nutrition advocacy

- Individuals in important positions or politics can play
 - ✓ *attention/compassion of the president, prime minister or the first lady can go a long way in nutrition advocacy*
 - ✓ *there are many examples in different parts of the world*
- Similarly, voluntary bodies, if properly motivated
 - ✓ *serve as excellent “spokesman” & act as pressure groups*
 - ✓ *better to be included in the national nutrition network*
 - ✓ *responsibility of nutrition officers to*
 - *identify such individuals*
 - *establish functional linkages with them*

Advocacy tools–EPIC ... (1)

- ❑ **E– Engage** your audience: story, a statistic, fact, image, value
 - Example: 1 in 7 pregnant women experience iron deficiency anemia and half or more do not receive iron-folate supplement. Iron deficiency anemia can have long-term consequences for both the mother and the fetus in the womb
- ❑ **P- State the **problem**:** you want to address or solve?
 - Example: Untreated iron-deficiency anemia may cause serious complications such as fatigue, headaches, heart problems, pregnancy complications, and developmental delays in children. Iron-deficiency anemia can also make other chronic conditions worse or cause their treatments to work poorly

- ❑ **I- Illustrate or inform** on the solution: the more specific the better. Paint them a picture of the solution
 - Example: it is evidence that iron deficiency anemia can be prevented through consuming iron rich foods, provision of supplements and or prevention of infections like malaria. It requires an integrated community-based program

- ❑ **C– Call** to action: what do you want them to do? Must be framed as something people can respond with yes or no
 - Example: We can't do this alone. Let's work together to combat the problem of iron deficiency anemia in our community, by figuring out both how to increase consumption of iron rich foods, access to supplements and prevent infections in our community

Chapter 5

Monitoring and Evaluation of Nutrition Programs

Chapter objectives

- At the end of the chapter, students will be able to:-
 - Define monitoring and evaluation (M&E)
 - Describe types of evaluation
 - Discuss needs of M & E
 - Explain the steps of evaluation
 - Discuss who need to do evaluation
 - Explain M& E framework
 - Discuss indicators for M & E

Introduction...(1)

- Evaluation and monitoring are vital as planning
- Planning for monitoring and evaluation
 - ✓ part of the overall planning process
- Without monitoring and evaluation,
 - ✓ there is every possibility that plans will be disrupted
 - ✓ *good planning alone does not ensure results*

Distinction between M & E... (1)

- Monitoring & evaluation are distinct but related efforts
- Though, both are critical program management tools,
 - ✓ they differ in scope & objectives
 - ✓ usually done by different people at different times
- Monitoring- continuous process
 - ✓ collection, analysis & use of information for decision-making
 - ✓ day to day follow up of activities
- Evaluation- judgment of completed project, program or policy
 - ✓ *its design, implementation and results*
- However, no a such difference between monitoring & process evaluation

Need of monitoring & evaluation...(1)

- Why M&E are needed? What if ignored?
- Without effective M&E, it is difficult to know whether
 - ✓intended results are being achieved as planned
 - ✓corrective actions are needed
 - ✓initiatives are making positive contributions/effects
- Thus, M&E help to improve performance
- Overall, there are two key reasons for M&E:
 - A.whether to continue the existing program or not
 - B.whether to implement similar programs elsewhere or not

Need of monitoring & evaluation...(2)

A. Whether to continue the existing program or not

- i.e. evaluation of an ongoing program/project...
 - ✓ usually called process evaluation or monitoring
- If the implementation process/impact is not as to the plan
 - ✓ may lead to redesigning/termination of the project/program

B. Whether to implement similar programs elsewhere

- i.e. evaluation of a completed program or a project...
 - ✓ usually called impact evaluation
- To decide whether to:
 - ✓ develop a new program/project or
 - ✓ implement a similar program at larger scale or elsewhere

Who need to do evaluation?...(1)

1. Programme managers

- to answer whether interventions proceed as expected

For example:

- If a school feeding program was developed to improve nutritional status and school retention
 - ✓ *it is important for the program manager to know how the program has worked in actual situations and to identify the areas of weakness and strength*

2. Senior administrators & decision makers

- to know whether a project/program be extended or repeated elsewhere

Who need to do evaluation?...(2)

3. Fund providers

- Sometimes evaluation of a program is more concern to the fund provider,
 - ✓ *whether to continue funding for similar projects/programs or not?*

4. Researchers and scientists

- Evaluation of a program can be interest to researchers/scientists
 - ✓ *test & generate evidences in links between program activities & outcomes*

Steps in evaluation...(1)

Step 1: Preliminary tasks

Step 2: Evaluating plan of project/program

Step 3: Evaluating implementation of project/program

Step 4: Evaluating impact of project/program

Step one: Preliminary tasks :

Should answer :-

- ✓ *Who will be doing the evaluation?*
- ✓ *For whom this evaluation will be for?*
- ✓ *What is to be evaluated?*
- ✓ *In what context?*
- ✓ *For what purpose?*
- ✓ *etc...*

Step two: Evaluating plan of program

- Before starting evaluation of the actual program,
 - ✓ important to examine plan of the program
- For example:
 - ✓ Objectives, targets, implementation plan, expected outcomes or impact
 - ✓ *implementation plan may include work plan, time frame & budget etc...*
 - ✓ *target may include area coverage and target population...*

Step three: Evaluating implementation of program

- Two major components of program evaluation:
 - ✓ Process evaluation: evaluating process of the delivery of the programme (*implementation*)
 - ✓ Impact/outcome evaluation: evaluating impact of program
- Process/implementation evaluation is important
 - ✓ to see the effectiveness of delivery of nutrition activities
 - ✓ whether the project activities have been implemented as intended and resulted in the expected outputs

Step four: Evaluating impact of program

- Main objective of any nutrition program:
 - ✓ *improve the nutritional status of the beneficiaries*
 - ✓ *thus, change in nutritional status has to be measured*
 - ✓ *measurement uses carefully selected sensitive indicators*

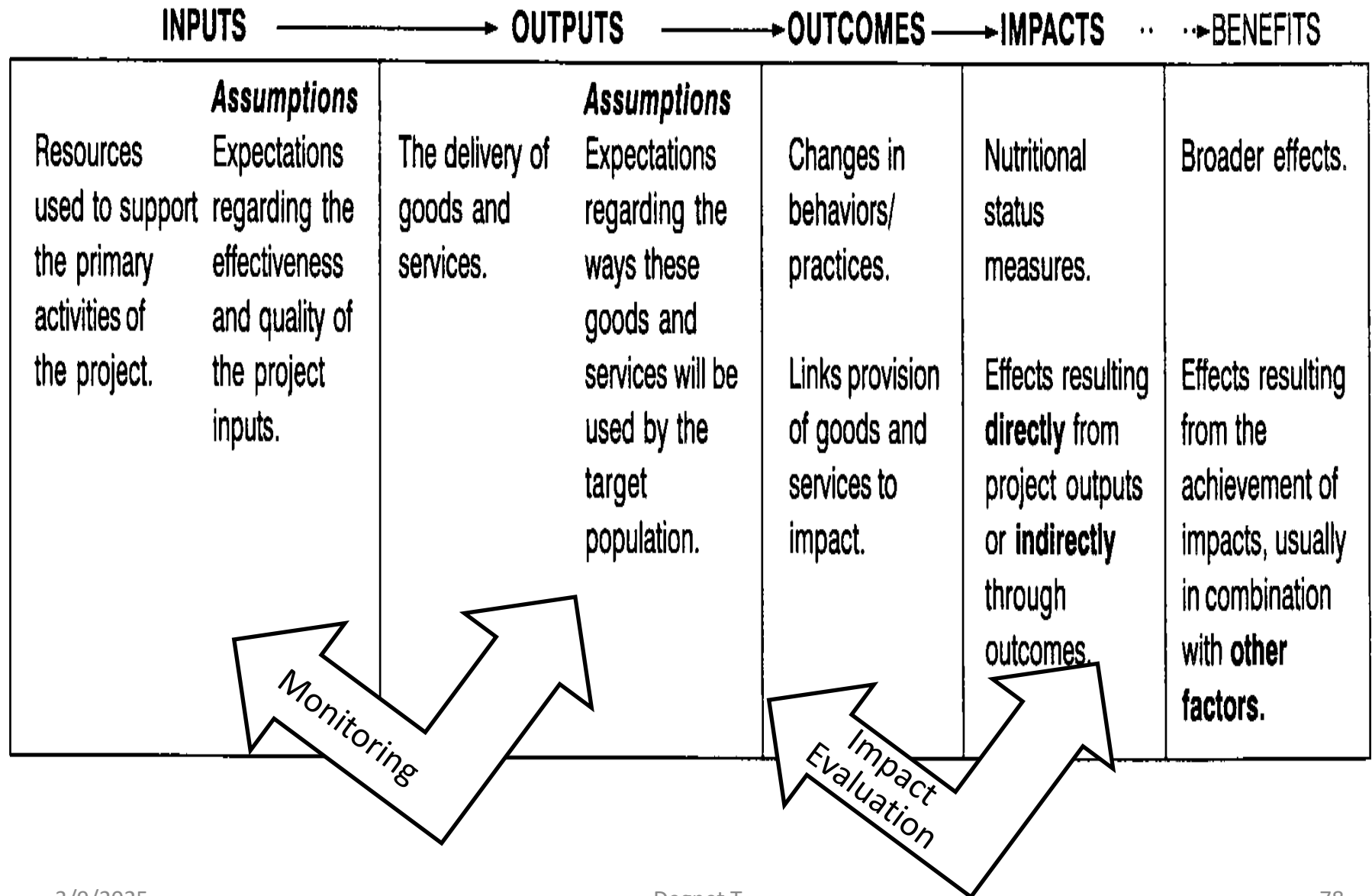
For instance,

- Feeding program aimed at alleviating PEM may use:
 - ✓ *body weight/height (body composition/growth indicators)*
 - ✓ *hemoglobin level*
- Selection of indicators vary from
 - ✓ *program to program or project to project*

Framework of monitoring and evaluation... (1)

- The framework of monitoring and evaluation systems
 - ✓ broken down into four principal components:
 - ✓ *inputs, outputs, outcomes, and impacts*
 - ✓ *closely related to steps of evaluation*

Framework of monitoring and evaluation...(2)



Indicators for M&E of nutrition programs...(1)

Monitoring implementation of programs

- Measures effectiveness of delivery of inputs and activities
 - ✓ Uses input & output indicators

Example

- For a program to promote healthier eating habits
 - ✓ Activities: training & educational campaigns
 - ✓ Implementation indicators thus may focus on:
 - ✓ *number & quality of educational materials produced*
 - ✓ *number of trainings held*
 - ✓ *number of trainers recruited*
 - ✓ *% of target population covered*
 - ✓ *number of promotion campaigns carried out, etc...*
 - ✓ Success of indicators depends on specific operational activities of the program/project

Evaluation of program impact

- Used to measure the effectiveness of the program
 - ✓ Uses outcome & impact indicators
- Comparison of indicators before & after implementation
 - ✓ *before–after comparison (influenced by factors)*
 - ✓ *use statistical adjustments*
- Using two areas/groups
 - ✓ *one benefiting from program & other not (control group)*
- Usually uses:
 - ✓ *behavior change and nutritional status indicators*
- What so ever, it has to be planned ahead

Planning matrix for M&E...(1)

Result	Indicator	Definition	Baseline	Target	Means of Verification		
					Source	Freq.	Person
Goal							
SO	Stunting	#of children with-2SD x100	XX	↓ X	Final evaluation	end	PM
		total #of children					
IR 1	trainings	# of trainings provided in the reference period	0	tt	Monitoring report	quarterly	M&E team
IR 2							
IR 3							
IR 4							

Planning matrix for M&E...(2)

Result	Indicator	Base-line	Target FY 1	Achieved FY 1	Target FY 2	Achieved FY 2
Goal						
SO						
IR 1						
IR 2						
IR 3						
IR 4						

Thank you

Good Luck!